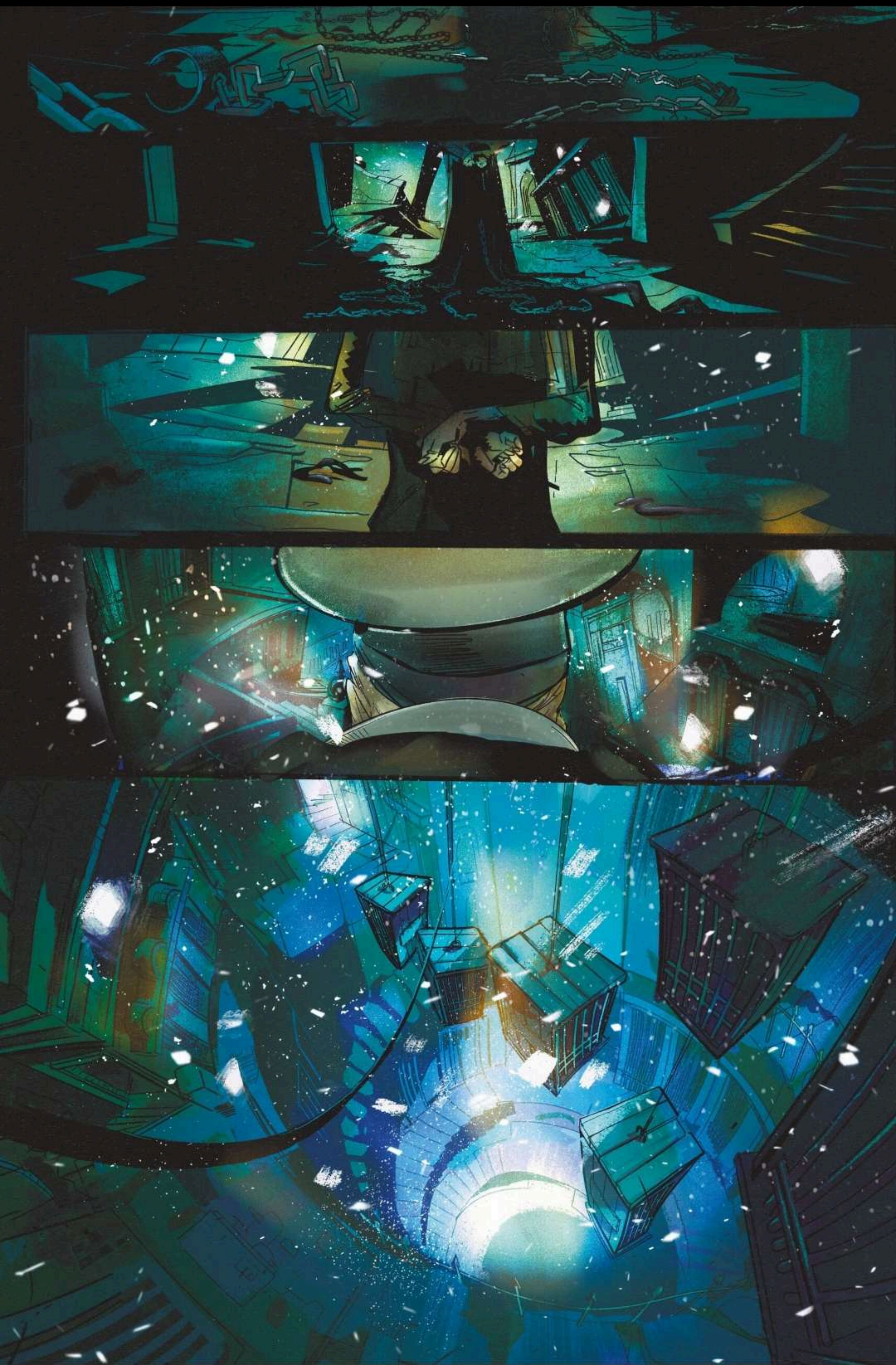
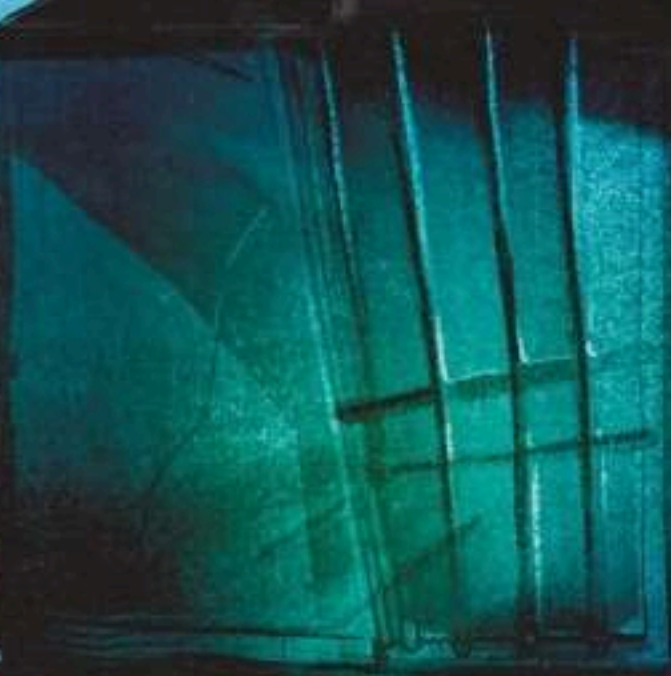
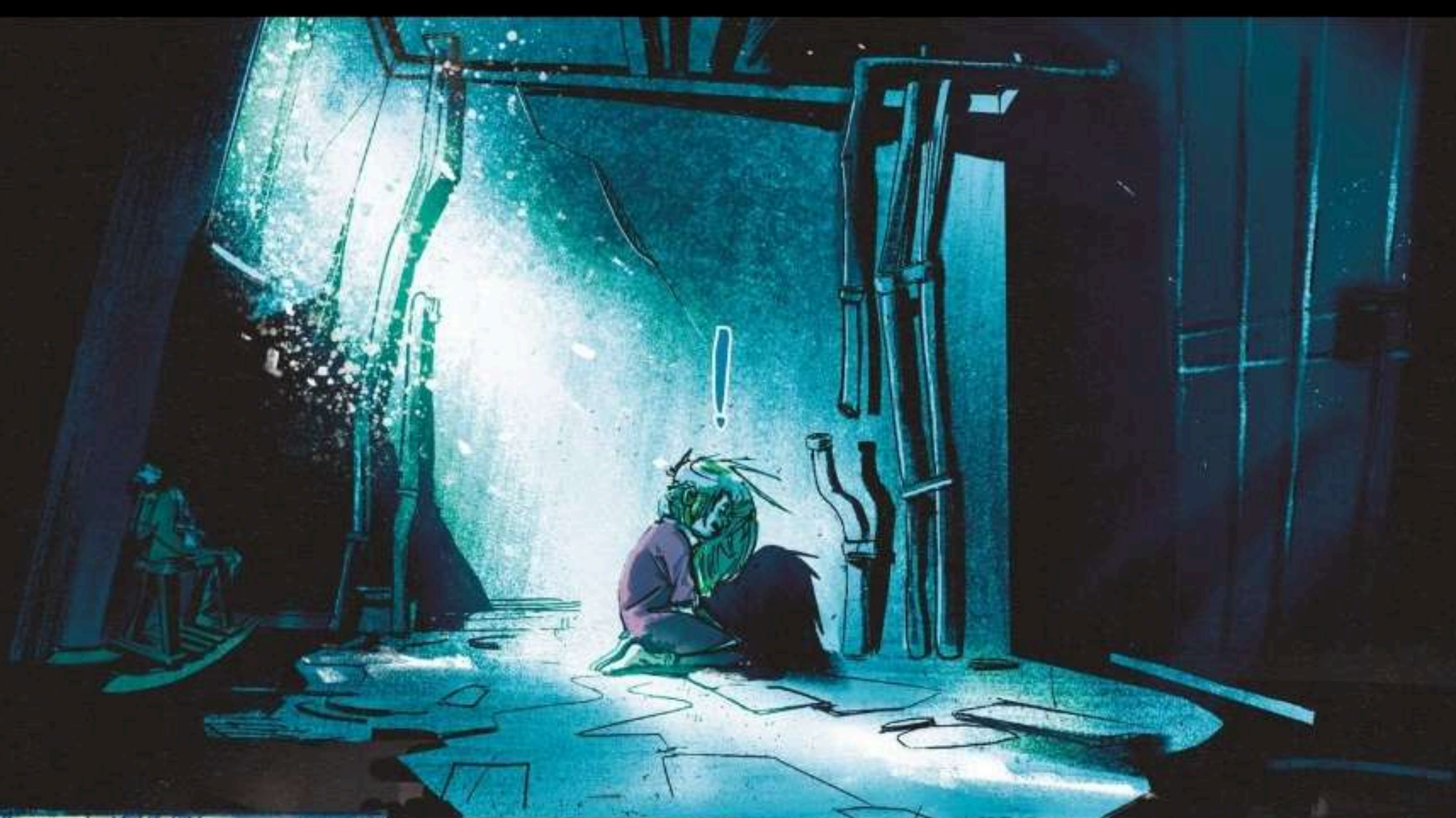






I don't remember
how I got here.



Doesn't matter.
I'm doing this. While
everything's quiet.

cold. winter
must be here
again.

Already.



The sleepy wind, crawling
fog, and stifled alleyway
cries at dawn.

To think this was
my favorite time of
year growing up.



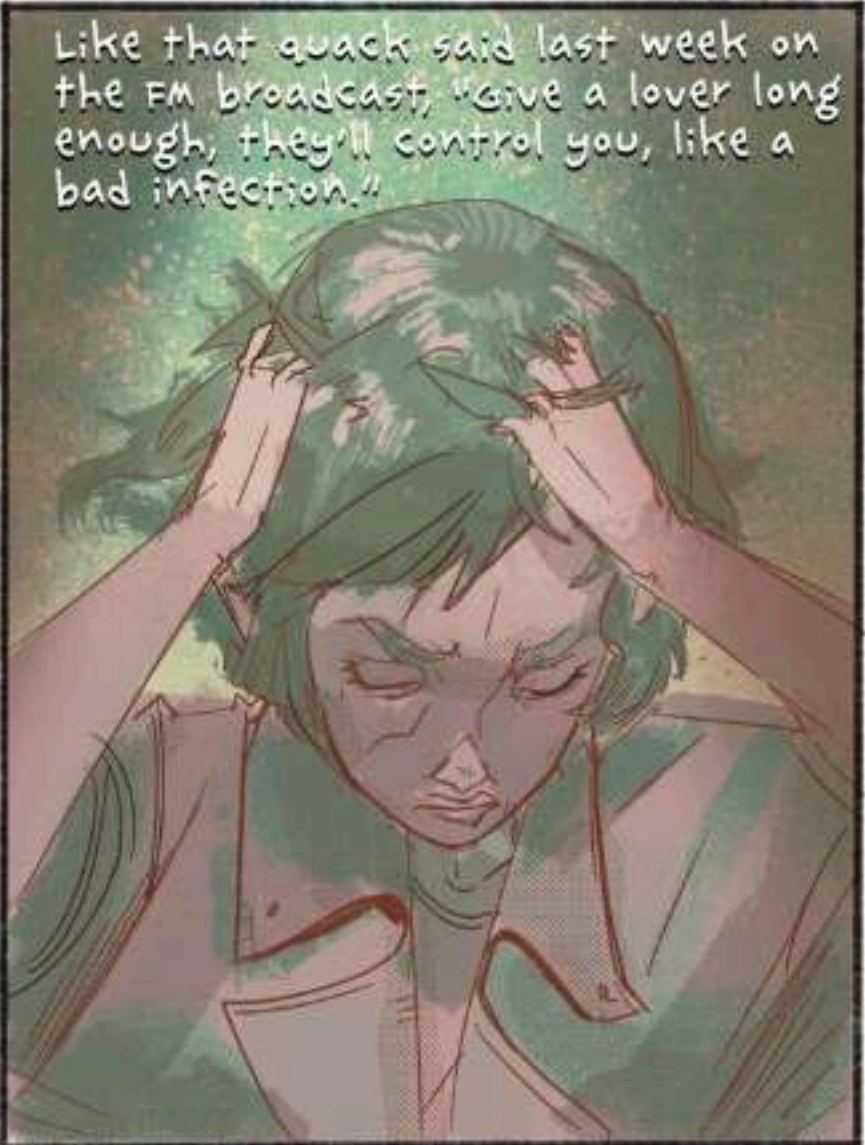
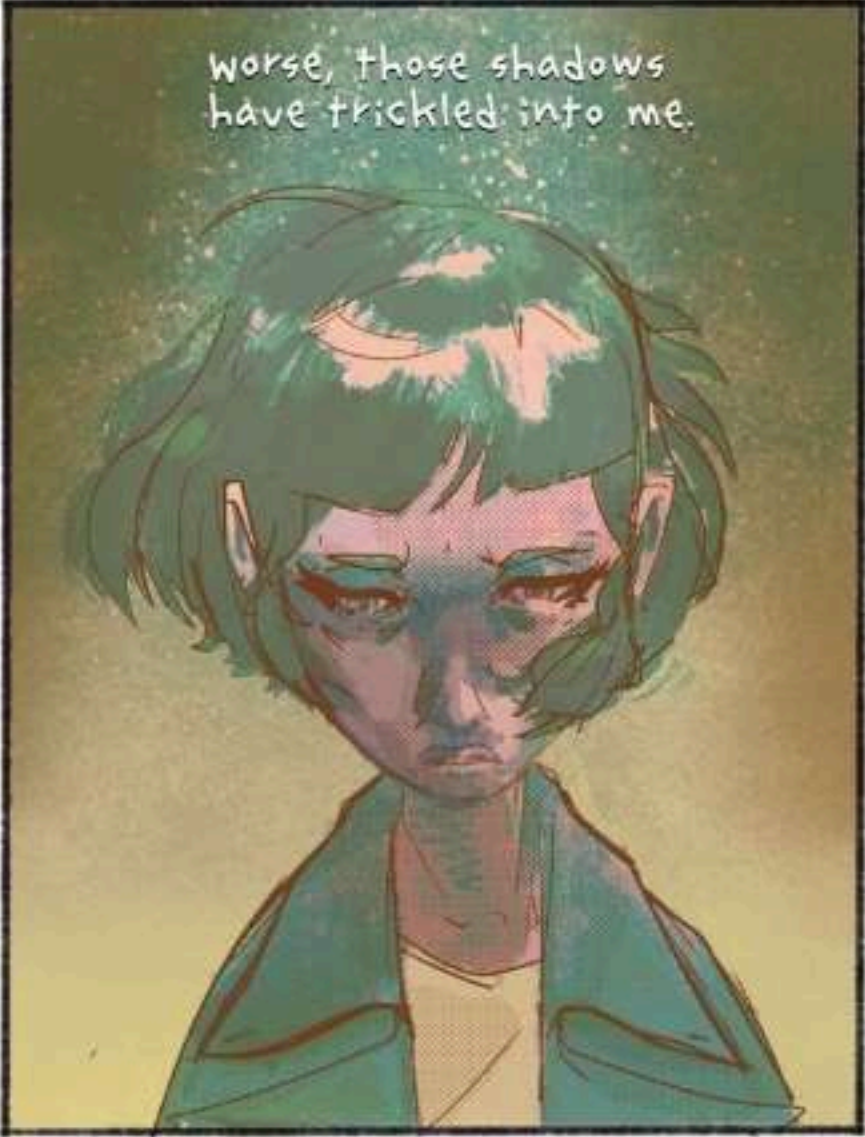
THE COUNTIES.
WEEKS EARLIER.

I hardly
recognize
it here
anymore...

Not that the
landmarks
have changed.

I've just seen
what's in their
shadows.







It's a trick they teach us to deal with jumpers. Use a non sequitur, confuse them, and move in.

I let it happen. Partly so I can come back when it's quiet.

Partly to get out of the cold.





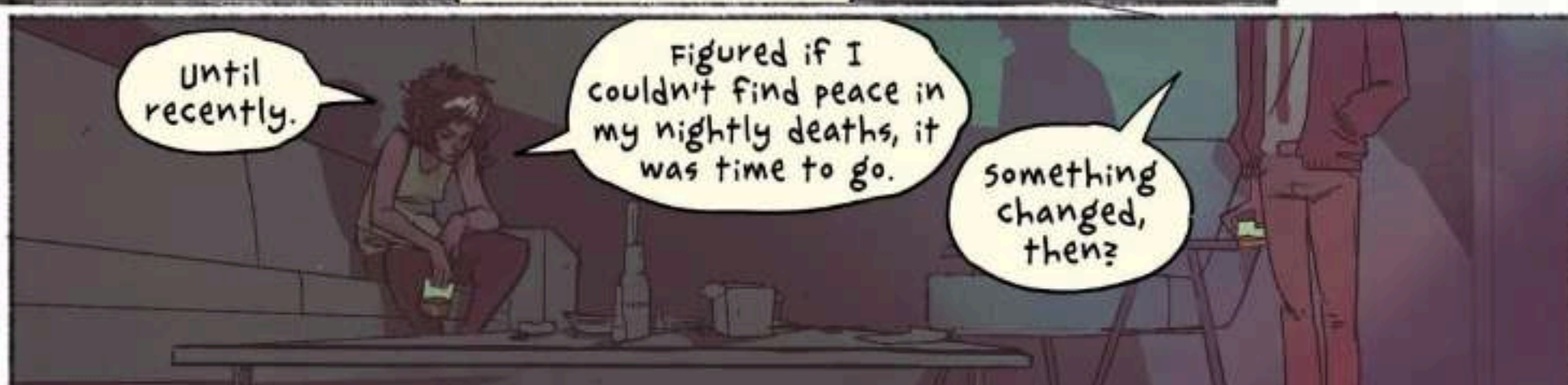






used to.

Tuned out that same duplicity that knotted your insides.



until recently.

Figured if I couldn't find peace in my nightly deaths, it was time to go.

Something changed, then?

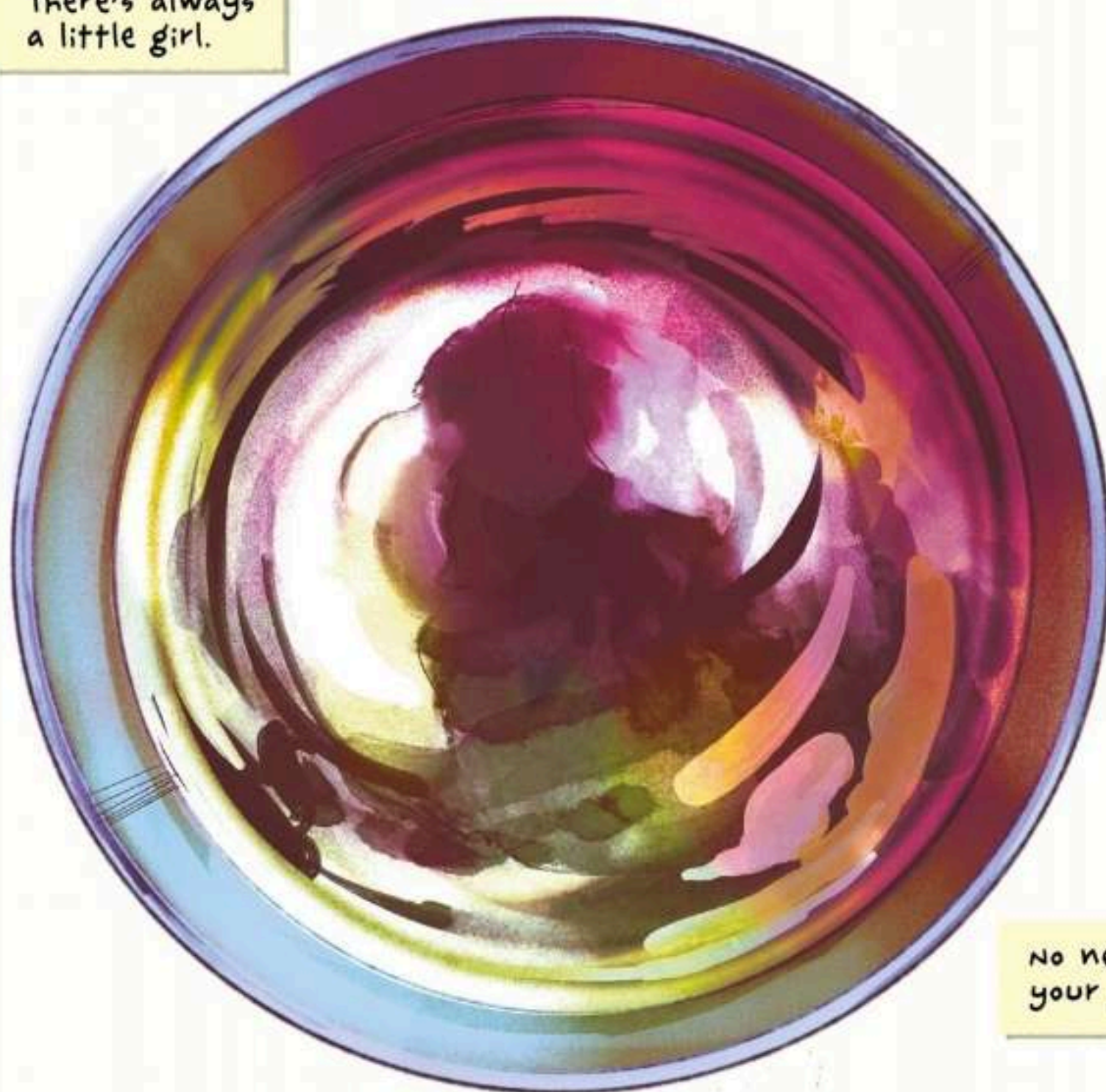


I fell in too far. Then the hole started filling up.

With pictures. Dreams that are strange, but familiar.

What'd you mean, familiar?

A little girl. There's always a little girl.



No need to spill your guts, Myra.

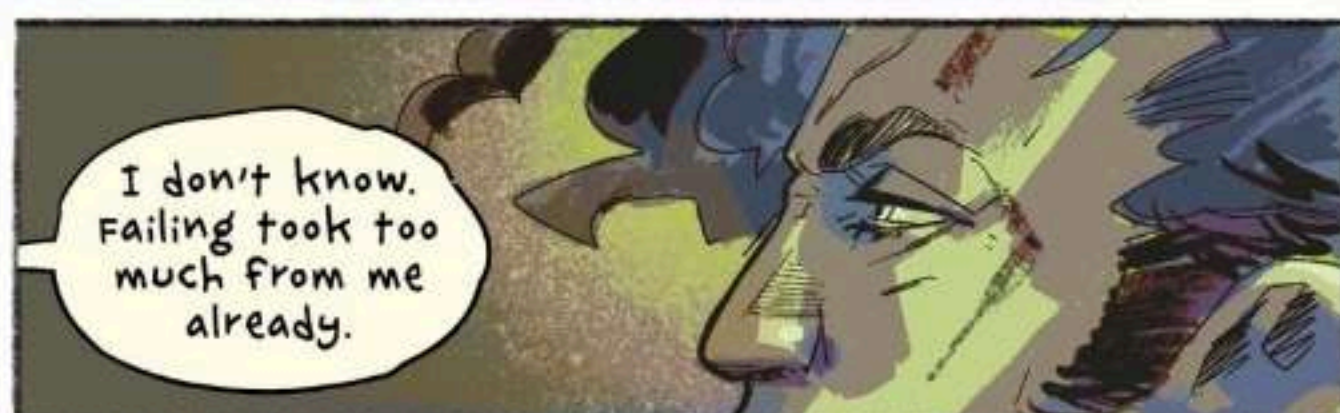


It doesn't matter.

It doesn't matter?

NO. It doesn't matter.





THWAAK











"...the fog remains dense on another A.M. in The counties."



The weather Bureau forecasts a lasting, week-long drizzle beginning this evening.



We'll be here, in your ear, as we always have been, with updates on the hour.

Here at REMS FM, the voice of The counties.



my head. God.

It feels as cracked as the sidewalks.

I've walked this route to the station countless times, yet it's more a maze than ever.













We've got a lead.

Happened last night. Call came from the psychiatric institute.

